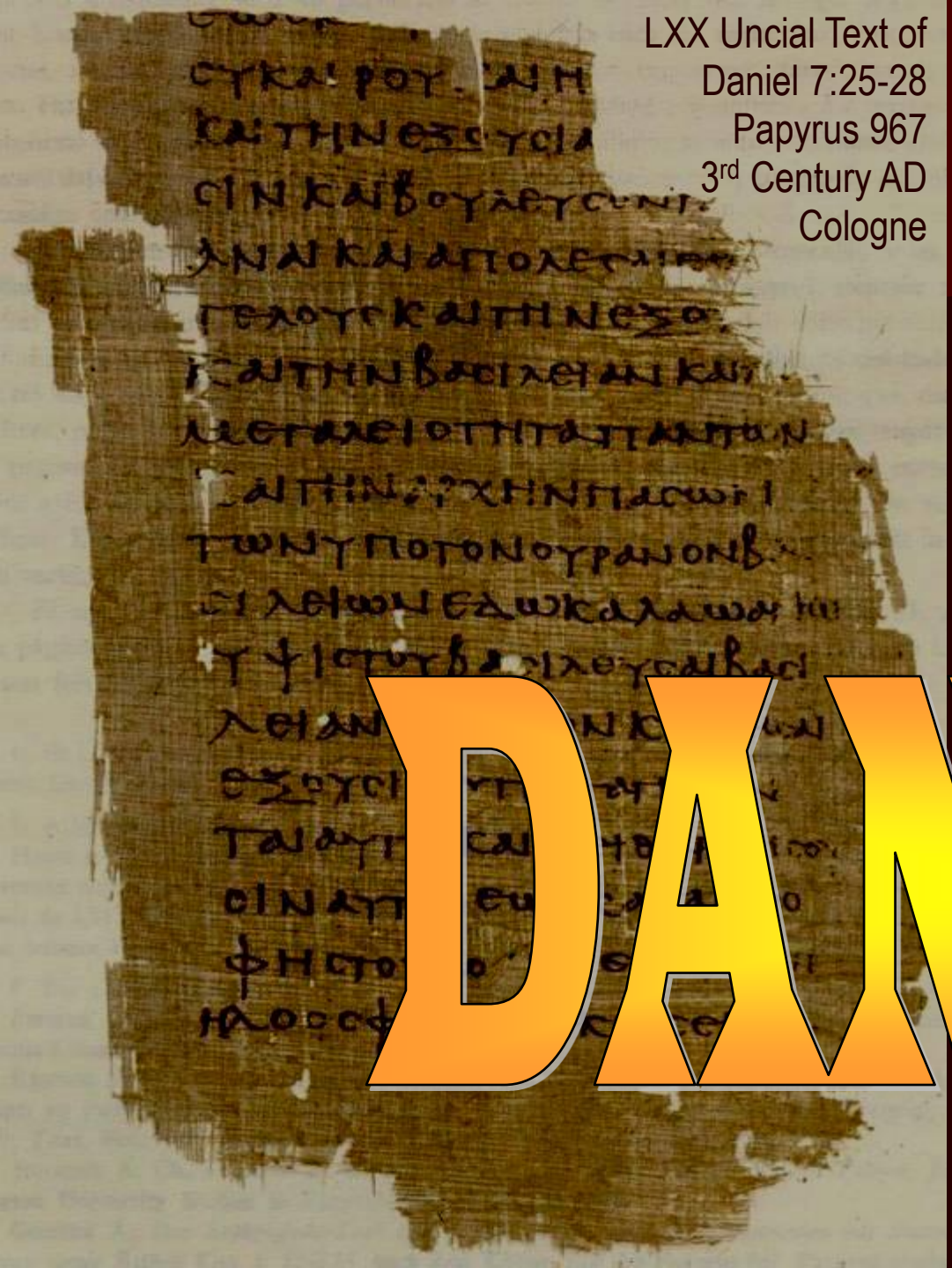


LXX Uncial Text of
Daniel 7:25-28
Papyrus 967
3rd Century AD
Cologne

Book of DANIEL

Daniel Chapter 8

Three Great Temple Desecrations

168 BC

Antiochus IV Epiphanes erects an altar to Zeus in the second temple (Da. 11:31)

AD 70

Titus destroys the second temple (Mt. 24:2)

END OF THE AGE (?)

St. Paul offers an enigmatic reference to the man of lawlessness sitting in God's temple (2 Th. 2:4)

Vision of the Ram & Goat

Chapter 7 concludes the Aramaic section of Daniel, and Chapter 8 resumes in Hebrew.

Unlike Chapters 2 and 7, there is widespread agreement concerning the interpretation of Chapter 8.

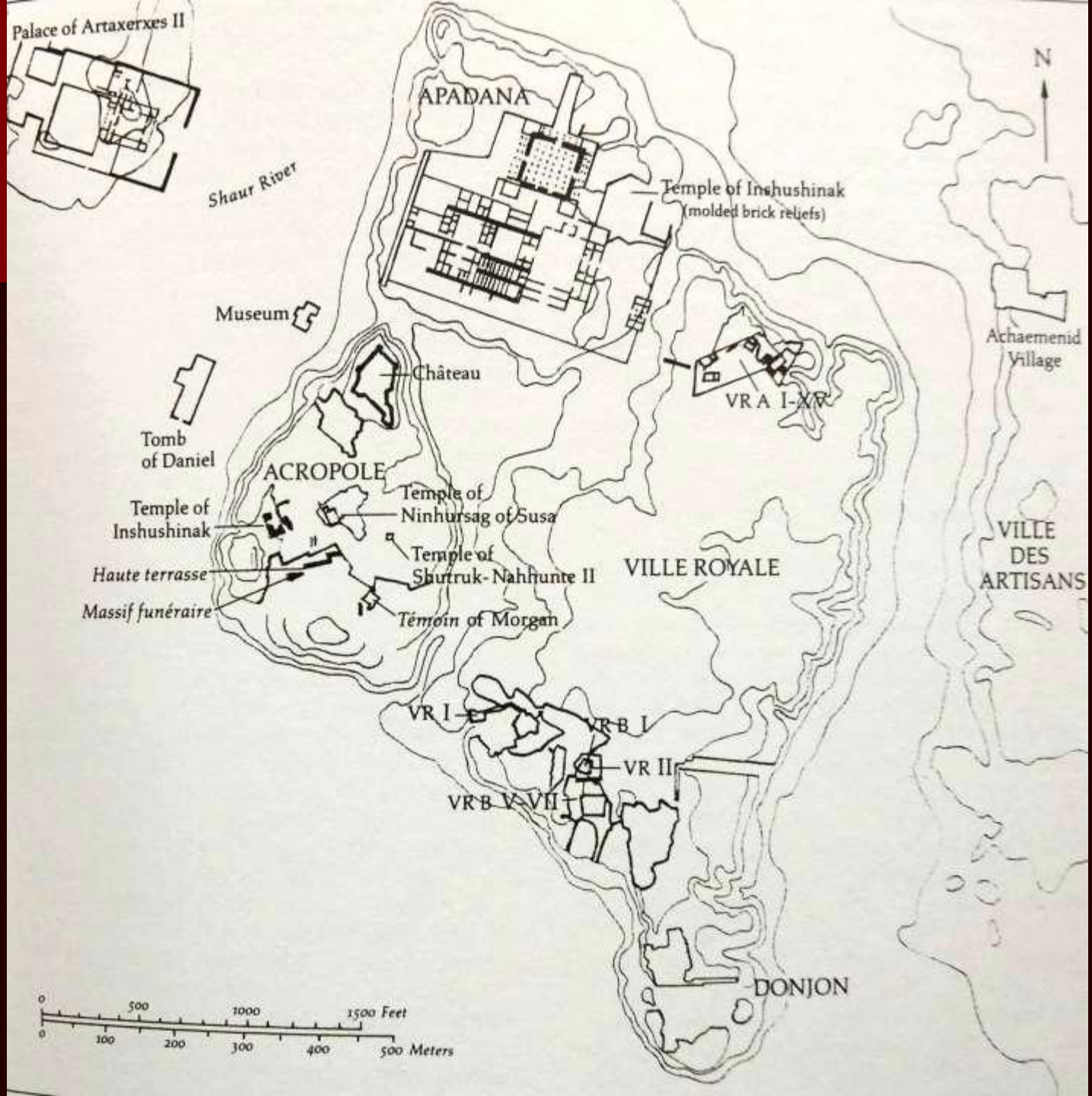
The vision describes the struggle between Persia and Greece.

The horns in the vision symbolize power, especially political power.

The Archaemenid Empire at its greatest extent under Darius III.

Susa

top plan of the excavations



Winged Lions, Susa

(Louvre, Paris)

Bull Capital, Susa

(Louvre, Paris)

Capital from one of 36 columns, each 20 meters high, in the great hall of the palace of Darius I in Susa (Louvre, Paris).

Tomb of Cyrus, discovered at Pasargadae (south-central Iran) in 1951; stands 36′ high. The inscription on the tomb was seen and recorded by Plutarch in AD 90.

Tomb of Cyrus

Bas-relief of Soldiers, Susa (Louvre, Paris)

Struggle Between Persia & Greece

TWO-HORNED RAM = Medo-Persia
GREAT HORNED GOAT = Greece
(8:20-21)

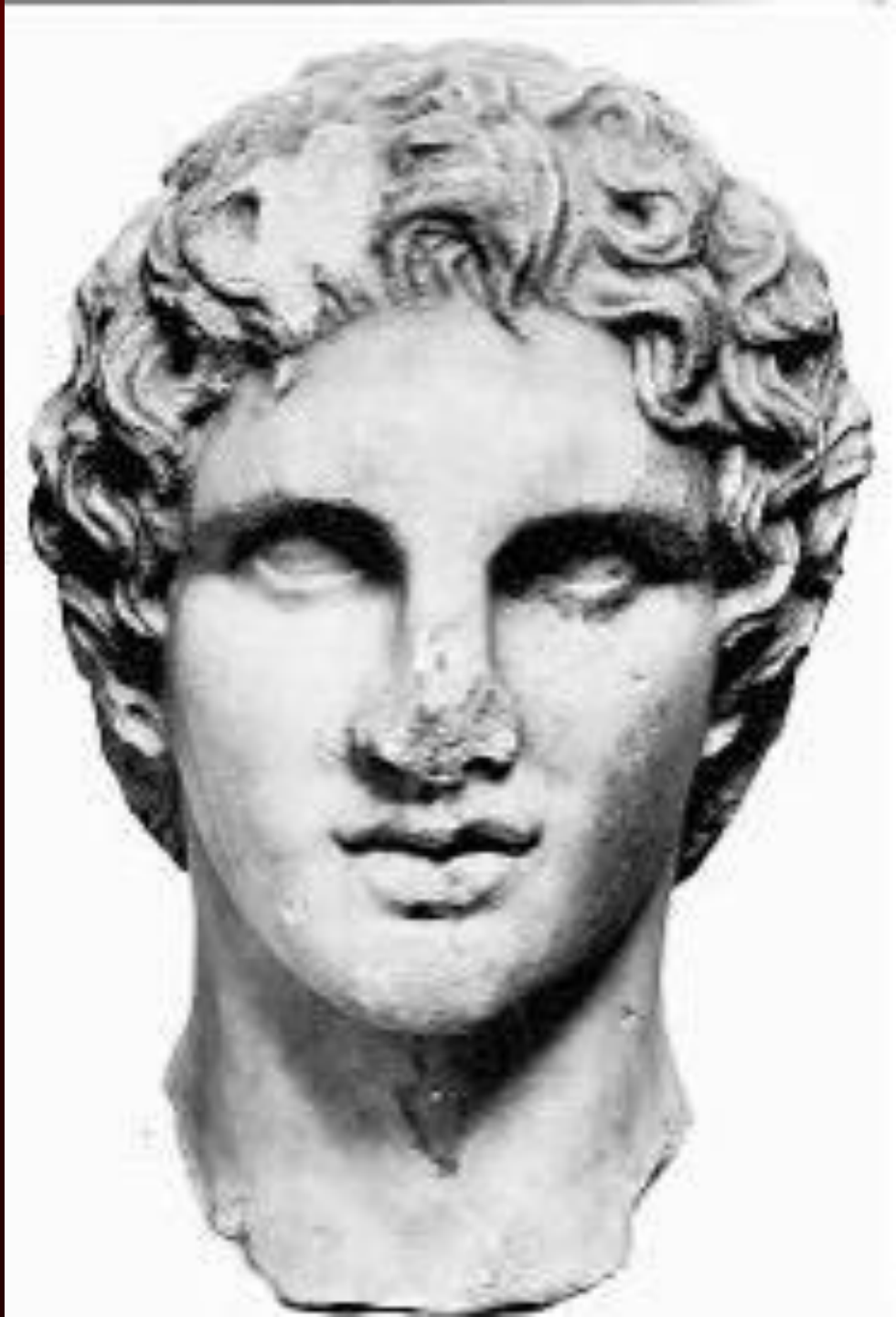
GOAT'S SINGLE HORN = Alexander the Great

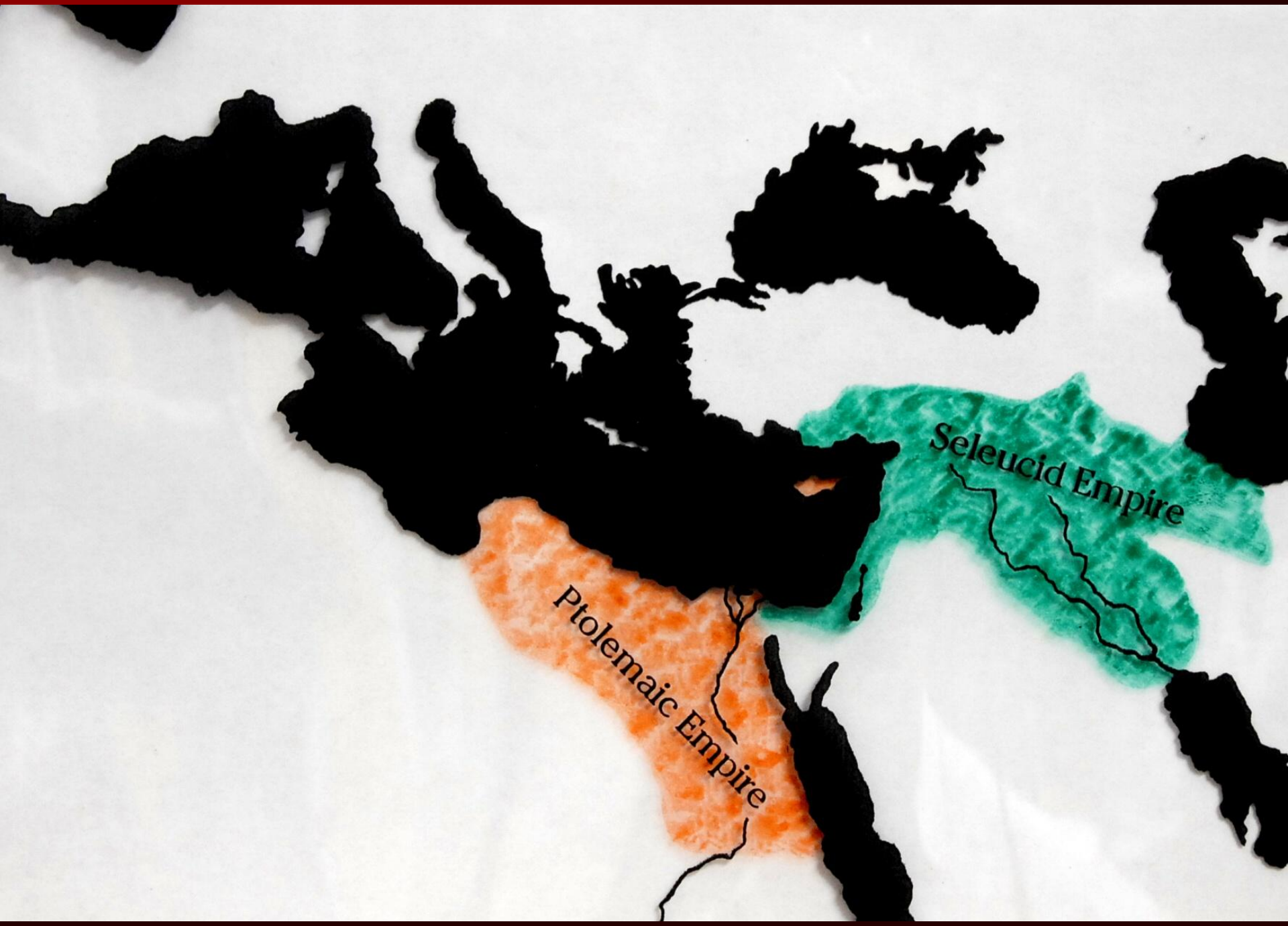
- Defeated Darius III in 333 BC at the Battle of Issus
- Conquered Palestine and Egypt
- Defeated Darius III again on the Plain of the Tigris
- Died in Babylon in 323 BC

FOUR PROMINENT HORNS = Alexander's Successors

- Seleucus (Persia, Mesopotamia, Syria); Lysimachus (Asia Minor, Thrace); Cassander (Macedonia); Ptolemy (Palestine, Egypt))
- Greek ideal (to spread Hellenism throughout the empire)
- Small horn = Antiochus IV Epiphanes, who attempted forced Hellenization of the Jews

Alexander the Great




Seleucid Empire
Ptolemaic Empire

Antiochus IV Epiphanes and the Jews

COIN OF ANTIOCHUS IV

reverse side shows a seated Apollo and bears the inscription: "Antiochus, image of God, bearer of victory"

The Greek rulers in Syria and Egypt, like the Pharaohs before them, took to themselves divine titles (Epiphanes = "God manifest")

Antiochus IV determined to abolish the Jewish religion and replace it with Hellenism:

- ***Looted the temple***
- ***Sacked Jerusalem***
- ***Deposed and executed the high priest, Onias III***
- ***Abolished the Tami'd (evening/morning sacrifices)***
- ***Forbade Sabbath observance***
- ***Outlawed circumcision***
- ***Burned the Torah scrolls***
- ***Erected an idol to Zeus in the sanctuary***
- ***Persecuted, tortured and executed Jews who resisted***

TEMPLE SACRILEGE AND THE TAMI'D

The *Tami'd* (the daily sacrifice), offered evening and morning, was abolished (8:11-12).

The sacrilege would continue for 2300 evening/mornings (8:13-14a).

Hence, the sacrilege would last for 1150 days, after which the sanctuary would be reconsecrated (8:14b).

Antiochus held Jerusalem by force for about 3 years and 3 months according to Flavius Josephus. In Jewish reckoning (lunar years), this equates to 1170 days if the final three months were a full 90 days. However, it was common Jewish practice to reckon any part of a month as a month. Hence, Josephus' reckoning probably is more or less equal to the 1150 days when the daily sacrifice was abolished.

The Archangels

Michael (Da. 10:13, 21; 12:1; Jude 9; 1 Th. 4:16; 1 Enoch 20:1)

Gabriel (Da. 8:16; 9:21; Lk. 1:19, 26; 1 Enoch 20:1)

Raphael (Tobit 5:4-5; 1 Enoch 20:1)

Uriel (2 Esdras 4:1)

Jeremiel (2 Esdras 4:36)

Suru'el (1 Enoch 20:1)

Raguel (1 Enoch 20:1)

Saraga'el (1 Enoch 20:1)

According to the Book of Tobit, there are "seven angels" who present the prayers of the saints before God (Tobit 12:15; cf. Rv. 8:2).